TEEG/TEJS/TEUP312
LITERACY ACROSS THE CURRICULUM

LISTENING AND SPEAKING AS LITERACY PRACTICES

GROUP THREE (3)

PRESENTATION OVERVIEW

- Explain listening and speaking as literacy practices
- Discuss concrete activities that can be used in some selected subjects/disciplines

INTRODUCTION

- If a learner can read but cannot explain what they read, are they literate?
- Literacy = Reading + Writing + Listening + Speaking + Viewing
- Bromley’s argument + George Sampson, 1922: "Every teacher is a teacher of English because every teacher is a teacher in English”
- Every subject has its own language. In Social Studies, we argue; in Science, we explain; and in Maths, we reason.

Modes of Language



Oral Language: Listening & Speaking (Oracy)



Written Language: Reading & Writing

Literacy: Developmental Progression



Oral Language

Receptive

Listening

Expressive

Speaking



Written Language

Reading

Writing

LISTENING & SPEAKING

Traditionally, literacy was narrowly defined as reading and writing print texts. Modern educational frameworks acknowledge that listening and speaking are foundational literacy practices through which students access, process, and express domain-specific knowledge.

Listening and speaking function as reciprocal, mutually reinforcing literacy processes/practices.



LISTEN.
LISTEN...

LISTENING



Listening is the active process of receiving, understanding, interpreting, and responding to spoken information. Listening is different from hearing.

It involves:

- Paying attention.
- Understanding the speaker’s message.
- Identifying important information.
- Interpreting meaning.
- Remembering relevant information.
- Responding appropriately.

LISTEN.
LISTEN...

LISTENING



Example

A learner may hear a teacher explaining how photosynthesis occurs, but listening means the learner is paying attention, identifying the key stages and being able to explain them afterwards.

SPEAKING

Speaking is the ability to communicate ideas, information, feelings and opinions through spoken language.

Effective speaking involves:

- Clear pronunciation.
- Appropriate vocabulary.
- Correct sentence structure.
- Organizing ideas logically.
- Speaking confidently.
- Adjusting language according to the audience and situation.
- Responding appropriately to others.



SPEAKING

Example

In Mathematics, a learner should not only calculate the answer but should be able to explain:

“I divided 60 by 5 because the question asks us to share 60 equally among five groups.”

This demonstrates mathematical understanding and speaking ability.



ENGLISH LANGUAGE



Classroom Activity: Think–Pair–Share
Sub strand: Story telling

- Teacher asks a question related to a lesson (a word from a story/text).
- Example: Why is honesty important?
- Pupils think silently for one minute.
- Each pupil pairs with a partner and discusses their answer for 3–4 minutes.
- Pairs share their ideas with the whole class while other pupils listen and ask questions

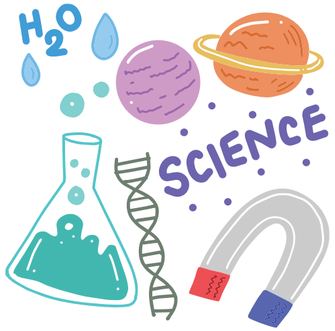
SCIENCE

Classroom Activity 1: Teacher Demonstration
Topic: Conversion and Conservation of Energy

The teacher demonstrates lifting a school bag from the floor onto a desk.

Learners listen for:

- The form of energy involved
- Where the energy comes from
- What happens to the energy
- Listening Task:
- Learners identify the important scientific information they heard and explain what they understood.



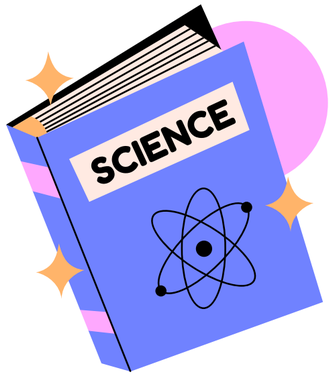
SCIENCE CONT'D

Classroom Activity 2: Explain Your Observation

After the demonstration, learners explain what happened using scientific language.

Learners are asked to say:

- I observed that...
- I think this happened because...
- The energy was transferred from... to...



Speaking Task:

Learners explain their observations and give reasons for their answers.

SOCIAL STUDIES

Classroom Activity: Group Debate
Topic: Environmental Pollution

Debate topic: “Plastic waste should be completely banned in Ghana”

- The teacher divides the class into two groups: **For and Against.**
- Each group is given 5 minutes to discuss the topic and prepare three reasons to support its position.
- After the preparation, representatives from each group present their arguments to the class.

Social Studies

SOCIAL STUDIES CONT'D

What learners will listen for:

While the other group is presenting, learners are required to listen for:

- The main argument being made.
- At least two reasons supporting the argument.
- Any examples or evidence provided.
- One point they agree or disagree with.

What learners will be asked to say:

Each learner must contribute at least one statement



ICT/COMPUTING

Classroom Activity: Group Presentation
Topic: Generations of Computers

- Learners are put into groups (depending on the class size). Each group is given one generation of computers to study.
- The groups discuss the main features of their assigned generation and prepare a short presentation.



ICT/COMPUTING CONT'D

What learners would listen for (Listening activity):

While another group is presenting, other learners listen for:

- The generation being discussed.
- The main technology used.
- The main features.
- One advantage or improvement over the previous generation.



ICT/COMPUTING CONT'D

Guided prompts for speaking activity:

What learners will be asked to present:

Each group explains its assigned generation to the class.

Learners should:

- Name the generation.
- Explain its main technology.
- Mention its main features.
- Explain how it improved on the previous generation.



SUMMARY

- Cognitive Tools: Listening and speaking are not secondary soft skills; they are the primary cognitive vehicles through which academic content is mastered.

- Explicit Scaffolding: Every teacher must explicitly define and scaffold what learners say and listen for in every single lesson plan.

- Equitable Access: Building talk-rich and listening-focused classrooms ensures equitable access to complex academic disciplines for all students.


Answer
Question

REFERENCES

Bearne, E. (Ed.). (2002). *Use of language across the primary curriculum*. Routledge.

Bromley, K. (2002). *Stretching students' vocabulary: Best practices for building the knowledge base*. Scholastic.

Bromley, K. (2007). Nine things every teacher should know about words and vocabulary instruction. *Journal of Adolescent & Adult Literacy*, 50(7), 528–537.

Mercer, N., & Dawes, L. (2008). *The value of exploratory talk in the classroom*. In N. Mercer & S. Hodgkinson (Eds.), Exploring talk in school (pp. 55–71). SAGE Publications.

Zwiers, J., & Crawford, M. (2011). Academic conversations: *Classroom talk that fosters critical thinking and content understandings*. Stenhouse Publishers

GROUP MEMBERS

GROUP THREE	
NAME	ID
EMMANUEL JOHNSON EGYIRE	22231578
SUZETTE KOKROKO	22247935
FRANCIS ODOI	22246953
JOANA ADOFO BOATENG	22245905
NADIA ELORM TETTEH	22041420
OPPONG GIDEON	22247578
RICHARD OMANE	22245286
RICHMOND OWUSU	22244998
AIDOO AFUA ATTA SANDY	22244759
EMMANUEL FORSON	22245517

THANK YOU!